

Liver Transplantation

CAG-00053N

Issue

Medicare covers “adult liver transplantation when performed on beneficiaries with end stage liver disease other than hepatitis B or malignancies ... when performed in a facility which is approved by HCFA as meeting institutional coverage criteria.” This policy has been in effect since July 15, 1996. The policy was written before the recent advances in hepatitis and cancer therapy. Medicare is now re-examining our coverage policy with respect both exclusions.

National Coverage Determinations

[NCD for Adult Liver Transplantation \(260.1\)](#) 

Benefit Category

Inpatient Hospital Services

Requestor Information

Requestor Name	Requestor Letter
Internal HCFA Request	N/A

Important Dates

Formal Request Accepted and Review Initiated
11/18/1999

Expected NCA Completion Date

02/16/2000

Public Comment Period

12/17/1999 - 01/17/2000

Decision Memo Released

12/02/1999

Contacts

Lead Analysts

Jackie Sheridan-Moore

Actions Taken

Ongoing

Review by OCSQ staff regarding information submitted on liver transplantation from numerous transplant centers.

April 23, 1999

Received letter from American Liver Foundation (ALF) dated April 22, 1999 submitting a monograph on "Hepatitis B: An Appropriate Indication for Liver Transplantation."

June 29, 1999

HCFA Administrator advises Congressman Waxman that we have received the ALF Monograph and indicates our interest in reconsidering the national coverage decision.

August 25, 1999

Director, Office of Clinical Standards and Quality (OCSQ) briefs HCFA Deputy Administrator on several liver transplant issues including our interest in reconsidering the national coverage exclusion of hepatitis B and cancer.

November 18, 1999

Director, OCSQ met with CAG staff to discuss a new national coverage decision.

December 2, 1999

[Decision Memorandum](#)  posted.